Contact

www.linkedin.com/in/vsistla (LinkedIn)

Top Skills

ML Commons
AI Alignment
AI Safety

Languages

English

Certifications

Competent Boards Climate Change Designation Program

Publications

NLP Model Performance for task "Text Entailment" With Switched Input Sentences

Vamsi Sistla

Founder
Sammamish, Washington, United States

Summary

- Experience in managing large-scale products and globally distributed teams in data engineering, data governance, data sciences & ML operations

- Leading various Gen AI and LLM initiatives internally at Nike

- Worked with leadership on large scale ML initiatives such as ML & Feature reusability, AB Testing With Multi Arm Bandits, AI Center of Excellence (CoE), and AI Strategy

- Experience in leading enterprises through digital transformations, cloud migrations and cloud first initiatives over the past 12 years. A proven leader in Data Engineering, Data Sciences & Machine Learning (MLOps/Applied AI)

- I have a successful track record of tactical execution in fast-paced software and technology development environments. Built large-scale n-tier & distributed applications for 20 years

- Expertise in AI/ML techniques, tools, and building frameworks

- Expertise in data analysis, modeling, visualization, and reporting tools and techniques

- Experience in consumer analytics for e-commerce & omni channel retail strategies

Experience

Stealth Startup
Founder
May 2024 - Present (1 year 8 months)
Greater Seattle Area

EARTH AND SPACE RESEARCH

Strategic Advisor

April 2024 - Present (1 year 9 months)

Seattle, Washington, United States

ESR has a non-profit research institute headquartered in Seattle, WA. Their organization is primarily funded by federal governmental agencies including the National Aeronautics and Space Administration (NASA), National Science Foundation (NSF), Office of Naval Research (ONR), and National Oceanic and Atmospheric Administration (NOAA).

Aerobotics7

Board Member

June 2022 - Present (3 years 7 months)

Greater Seattle Area

Aerobotics7 builds AI-powered Drone-tech platform to detect and destroy landmines

One of the products EAGLE A7 is an AI-enabled Drone-tech platform that can autonomously detect, map, and can even destroy landmines and other buried/ non-buried ordnances, remotely without any human risks.

Unlike the current approach of manual demining, It is not only significantly safer but more than 50X faster than traditional approaches. It has the capability of detecting modern composite (plastic-based) landmines and explosives, which are not detected by currently available methods. It also gives users accurate positioning of mines and even the capability of remotely detonating them.

Women in Voice

Strategic Advisor

July 2020 - Present (5 years 6 months)

Provide guidance and support to WiV leadership on their growth, venture financing, community building and accelerators

Nike

3 years 1 month

Global Director, Consumer Data Science (Product Creation & Merchandising)

January 2023 - May 2024 (1 year 5 months)

Greater Seattle Area

* Founding leader of this brand new group started in January, 2023. Transforming Nike's Product Creation & Merchandising business with data science & machine learning. Leading a team that builds AI ML insights for Product Line Managers, Planners, Merchandisers, Designers & Developers - who are responsible for building next generation (Shoes & Apparel) products at Nike.

* Work with cross functional leadership across digital product creation, product merchandising & member analytics, merchant platform engineering, consumer market research and key lines of business (LOBs) to transform product creation at Nike

*Bringing scaled analytics to the end-to-end workflow of product creation & and merchandising - by leveraging AI ML capabilities. Leading teams building product & member embeddings, clustering, behavior-based consumer segmentation, group-based personalization, carry over recommender, product pulse and city trendsetters and others.

Director, Enterprise AI ML Reusable Products & Services (Data Pipelines, Feature Store, Model Zoo)

May 2021 - April 2023 (2 years)

Greater Seattle Area

Single-Threaded Leader (STL) running Data Science Common Pipelines, Models & Platform team at Nike.
Establishing the center of excellence (COE) for consumer data science practice. Keen on organization development, values, virtues, and influencing without authority.

+ Responsible for building out the newly created cross-functional team and leading the transition of Nike’s Data Science capabilities to cross functional enterprise solutions.

+ As a horizontal function, the Reusable Models & Platform team collaborates with vertical data science teams - Personalization, Search, Core Commerce, Communications, Sports Activity, Product Design & Merchandising, and more.

+ Reusable ML include Data Pipelines, Feature Store, Reusable Models, Model Factory, Workflow Orchestration, ML Experiment Management, ML Testing and Governance (privacy/fairness/biases), and so on. Driving product adoption and internal team customer success

+ Lead and build Supply chain, merchandizing, Inventory Aware & location aware data pipelines and ML Models to address various use cases - Search, Recommendations, Personalization, Targeted Communication, Sports Activity, and Content.

Unify Consulting
Director, Data Science & Machine Learning
August 2019 - April 2021 (1 year 9 months)
Greater Seattle Area

I built the best data science & MLOps group on the Northwest. Ran teams and digital transformation initiatives at various fortune 500 companies.

Developing leaders and teams. Building strong relationships and collaboration, managing trusted stakeholder relationships internally and externally.

1. Machine Learning Architect & building MLOps on Azure

o Operationalizing existing ML Models using Azure Machine Learning Service(AMLS) and Azure Databricks (ADB) with ADLS. Building automation, scale, and end to end "productionization" of ML Operations. Built solutions using Jupyter notebooks, ML Pipelines, ML Model experiments using MLFlow. Successfully implemented and deployed ML Model training and scoring into Production infrastructure (Applied ML). Handled data engineering aspects of the project by transforming Parquet format files from ADLS to CSV and Tabular data in AMLS.

o Help in building propensity models to predict customer journey in acquiring Microsoft’s products. Implemented various clustering techniques to depict the customer journey.

2. Principal Machine Learning Lead for a Life Sciences Company

o Building & validating Hypothesis for Cell Line Development using AWS Sagemaker and S3 Datalake. Leading Data Governance for the business

Apart from standard ML platforms & tools, I have experience managing projects building enterprise data streaming platforms that eventually leveraged by Machine Learning Projects. Technologies used - Striim, DataBricks Delta Lake, Apache Spark, and Redis

BSQUARE

Sr. Director of Product Innovation (Machine Learning, Internet of Things & Architecture)

November 2017 - June 2019 (1 year 8 months)

Greater Seattle Area

Leadership

o Define the company's data science/ML product & services strategy with leadership

o Collaborate with the executive team on the partnerships, go to market & business growth strategies

o Managed group P&L, budget & utilization metrics.

Product & Engineering

o Roadmap, build & manage Data Science Products, Tools, Automation and Services using agile & lean methodologies

o Demonstrated "bias towards action" leadership

o Ran cross-organization projects pulling in engineering, DevOps and QA resources in Taiwan/UK

o Lead with bleeding edge prototyping using emerging technologies and platforms such as AWS Managed Services, Azure and open source DS platforms.

o Work with sr. architects in defining and implementing scalable and secure architecture for products and services

o Built scalable, secure and high-availability products & services

o I work with CTO/Product Managers to bring innovation to Bsquare's DataV product. Work in coordination with Bsquare Solution Architects and Core Engineering Group.

o Lead Research and prototyping work in emerging areas - leveraging AWS, Azure, Machine Learning and Data Sciences. We also focus on creating automation of processes and standard patterns.

o Ran large scale AB testing projects for fortune 500 clients.

o Make use of AWS & Azure core & managed services.

People Management

o Recruit, retain & grow top-notch ML engineers (SDEs), data scientists, principal engineers for the group.

o Mentor/guide all direct reports and cross-functional teams on company & group direction, customer priorities and their own individual career goals.

Customer, Sales & Marketing

o Drive digital transformation for Customers in Transportation, Retail, Energy & Manufacturing.

o Identify opportunities to co-create products & services with internal & external customers

o Work with product marketing, finance departments on business, marketing, lead gen & sales.

Freedom Mortgage

Vice President of Engineering/Technology

July 2015 - June 2016 (1 year)

Greater Seattle Area

• Work with EVP & SVP on setting digital mortgage product & services strategy

• Managed a team of contract developers, product managers, project managers & QA

• Manage vendor relationships

• Leading the enterprise technology architecture for Business Innovation Group within Freedom Mortgage (nations top 5 Lender)

• Digitizing Mortgage Lending Services – capturing borrower information, pulling borrower data from 3rd party sources, OCR, rules & decisions engine integration (BPM), loan product & pricing and loan servicing – all via mobile and web interfaces.

• Help manage and architect digital loan platform on Amazon AWS using – EC2, S3, Amazon RDS, Mongo DB, Node.Js, Express, Apache Spark, Tableau, and MySQL.

• Prototyping and POC using following technologies - AWS, Google Cloud, Node.Js, Tableau, MySQL

OfferBoard (Acquired by Entoro Capital Group)

CTO

January 2013 - July 2015 (2 years 7 months)

Seattle/Greater New York City Area

Acquired by Entoro Capital Group in February 2017. (8 months CTO Consulting)

• Came on board as a transition CTO to migrate original platform to Entoro and do their 1st launch.

• Leading launch of Investment Banking Platform for Oil & Natural Gas Sector for Entoro Group

---

OfferBoard is a global private placement platform for equity offerings. OfferBoard works with emerging growth companies seeking $1–$25 million in equity capital from accredited investors and companies, providing access to investor networks designed to make capital raising easier and more efficient. The OFFERBOARD team includes international business leaders from companies such as Second Market, Goldman Sachs, JP Morgan Chase Bank and the Asian Development Bank, among others.

As CTO these are my responsibilities -

Leadership
o Provide technology leadership & oversee technology & product management
o Work closely with the CEO on strategy, fundraising, and customer acquisition efforts

People Management
o Build out engineering & products teams
o Manage outsourced consultants, designer, and QA resources

Product & Engineering
o Establish world-class standards and technical operations to deliver consistent, high-quality platform across teams
o Play a key role in building financial and transaction-intensive web platform over Azure Cloud Services (IAAS and PAAS) and Salesforce. Led integration on IBM SoftLayer and Amazon AWS platforms.
o Assist in port legacy. ASP and VB Portal into Azure Cloud Infrastructure. Maintain multi-cloud installations with Heroku.
o Customized and built regulatory compliant modules on top of Salesforce Enterprise Cloud. Integrated with DocuSign, NetDocuments and Conga Composer.
o Built Secure, SOC & ISO 27K & FINRA compliant infrastructure.
o Integrate third-party tools, such as Google Analytics, Mailchimp, Marketo, Mandrill, Kiss Metrics, Early IQ, New Relic, and JIRA.

LIVESTAGE° and Telvetto

CTO

January 2011 - May 2013 (2 years 5 months)

Greater

August 2012 to May 2013

LIVESTAGE is a 360° digital venue for live music that will stream concerts live and on-demand with a spectrum of interactive features. Leveraging the groundbreaking 360HD° live streaming workflow, fans can choose between 360° and HD angles in the crowd and onstage. LIVESTAGE will enable fans to get closer to their favorite artists on the largest stage in the world.

Jan 2011 to July 2021

Telvetto is a SAAS based data curation platform for media & entertainment applications/products.Televetto's primary customer base includes second screen applications for TV, real time media, news & gaming applications and portals. Worked with co-founders to build the product, technology and business strategy. Focused on customer acquisition and fund raising for the company.

Rovi

5 years

Director, Mobile/Social Platform Product Management

July 2010 - January 2011 (7 months)

Responsible for Mobile and Social TV Product Management.

Building next generation Rovi products on iPhone, iPad, Android, Connected Tablets, Connected TVs and Google TV.

Key responsibilities include - Product ideation, Product Road mapping, Research, Business Modeling, and Product Management.

Director, Mobile Product Development

September 2009 - January 2011 (1 year 5 months)

- Leading a cross functional team to focus on design and development of suite of Web Services for Rovi's Mobile Customers and Partners.

- Define new functionality associated with Syndication Services for Mobile and Web 2.0 Customers - Service Operators, Telcos, Consumer Electronic OEMs, Automotive, etc.

- Leading definition and prototyping in emerging areas within Mobile and Web Services.

- Evangelize and Influence technology decisions for Mobile and Web Services. Work closely with cross platform engineering resources in articulating product definition and market positioning.

Director, Mobile Solution Sales and Professional Services
May 2008 - January 2011 (2 years 9 months)

Macrovision has acquired TV Guide.

Mobile solution and professional services expert. Focus in creating rich media guidance solutions on portable and mobile services.

Apart from mobile services, will be focusing on technology integration between mobile products and connected living ecosystem. Working with CE open networking standards such as digital living network alliance (DLNA) to integrate, connect and control CE, Portable and Mobile devices.

Will be involved in integration efforts across CE vendors, System Operators, Online Portals and Content Publishers.

Negotiate contracts with vendors and partners for the mobile group. Responsible for vendor relationships and RFP process. Handled group requisitions, receiving, purchase requests and purchase orders through Oracle E-Business Suite.

Manage and support mobile Ad Sales efforts in managing mobile advertisement vendors, inventory and technical integration. Manage mobile adv vendors such as TSM, EnPocket, AdMob, MillennialMedia, Quattro Wireless, and 4Info (SMS).

Implemented Dynamic Ad Serving Solution (using 3rd party ad serving platforms) to increase the fill rate and prioritize based on higher CPM rates.

Creating B2B mobile products and syndication services that are equivalent to www.allmusic.com, www.allmovie.com, www.allgame.com and www.tvguide.com

Director, Mobile Product Management, Operations & Operator Relations
August 2006 - January 2011 (4 years 6 months)

Manage On Deck as well as Off Deck applications for TVGuide mobile group. As part of my mobile program management responsibilities, I liaise with other

group program managers on a weekly basis to discuss impediments, progress, and strategy at a cross platform level and identify appropriate future steps and recourse.

I oversee development progress of developers and designers create weekly status reports, identify impediments and their impact on the deliverable schedule and overall project.

Drive engineering and operator/partner relationships for TVG Mobile Entertainment group.

Applications including Guidance, Videos (ondemand/streaming and download) and Broadcast ESG/Video. Platforms/OS and technologies include WAP, J2ME, Windows Mobile, Brew, WIPI and so forth.

Director, Mobile Entertainment
2006 - January 2011 (5 years)

ABI Research, Inc
Director of Broadband, Digital Home and Digital Media
December 2002 - August 2006 (3 years 9 months)

* Provide competitive assessments of emerging technological & market developments that impact future revenue and sales opportunities for ABI clients.
* As principal analyst perform technology and market research offering quantitative, qualitative and revenue analysis.
* Manage market research products and services in consumer electronics (DTV, DVD, etc), digital media, DRM, CA, broadband, cable, satellite, telco and WiFi.
* Work on high value custom projects for S&P 500 clients in building financial, competitive and growth models.
* Speaker and moderator at major industry shows and conferences.
* Published over 40 research reports and quarterly updates.

Appeared on TV on CNBC Squawk Box and Canadian Report on Business (Rob TV).

Appeared on CE Channel during CES 2005 in Las Vegas, interviewed on NPR Market place and CNET Tech Radio. Cited by AP, Reuters, Wall Street

Journal, Dow Jones Newswire, USAToday, Forbes, TWICE, BusinessWeek and CIO.

Education

UC Berkeley School of Information

Master of Information and Data Sciences - MIDS, Data Sciences and Machine Learning

Stanford University

APM (Certification), Project Management & Strategy

Oakland University

MS, Mechanical Engineering

KL College of Engineering

Btech, Mechanical Engineering